

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST · NATIONAL ROAD SAFETY BOARD

Crashfree India

**Application to Working Group 2:
Safe Roads, Speeds & Vulnerable Road Users**



Expert-guided student audits that end in built fixes, 31 sites, 7 completed



Technology the system uses: AI enforcement with police, public tracking dashboards



Published audit reports and policy research, anchored to the IRC codes



A letter to the Working Group



New Delhi · August 2026

Respected Chairperson and Members of Working Group 2,

Crashfree India is a young road safety nonprofit, registered as the Vision Zero Trust, co-founded with the Indian Road Safety Council, and backed by a three-year, US\$3 million commitment from Cars24. We work alongside public authorities: our student teams audit dangerous locations under senior experts, our technology helps police and administrators see their own pipelines, and our support tools stand with families after a crash. MS Dhoni carries this message to the country as our Goodwill Ambassador.

In our first year we audited 31 high-risk locations across 18 cities, secured 25+ written approvals from road-owning authorities, and saw 7 sites fully implemented with 6 more partially built, each tracked on a public dashboard. SATARK, our AI enforcement platform, has screened over 3,00,000 vehicles for police in Jaipur and Bengaluru and has now reached Gurugram. Four open-data platforms, the Aasha victim chatbot and hospital helpdesks complete the picture.

The pages that follow introduce the organisation briefly, then set out the work most relevant to this Working Group in the detail its mandate deserves. Everything shown is running today, is public, and is offered to the Board without cost. We would be honoured to contribute.

Respectfully,

Akhtar Hussain

Mission Lead, Crashfree India · akhtar@crashfreeindia.org · crashfreeindia.org

Five sections, **three minutes** to skim

1



About us, and how we work

Who we are, our approach to the road crash crisis, and why this Working Group.

04 – 06

2



What we have built

Every public-facing programme, audits, enforcement tech, victim support, open data, youth, campaigns.

07 – 14

3



Our people

The team, its capabilities, and the expert bench around the work.

15 – 16

4



Project Rakshak in depth

The deep dive matched to this Working Group's mandate, evidence, method, results.

17 – 26

5



How we can contribute

Four concrete, no-cost offers to the Working Group.

27 – 28

Crashfree India: a nonprofit that adds **capacity** to road safety work

Registered as the Vision Zero Trust · Co-founded by Cars24 and the Indian Road Safety Council · Working since June 2025 · New Delhi

- 

Evidence first

Structured field audits, file reviews and research to official standards, not opinion.
- 

Institutional collaboration

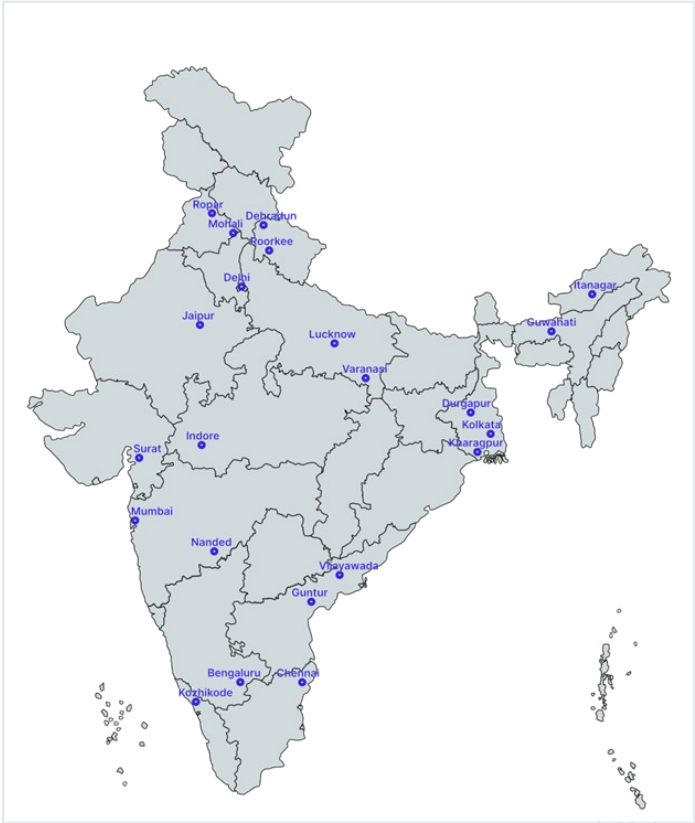
We work through PWDs, NHAI, transport departments, police and District Road Safety Committees.
- 

Youth-led capacity

Trained student teams from IITs, NITs and SPAs add the auditing hands the system needs.
- 

Technology for follow-through

Public dashboards track every recommendation from submission to completion.

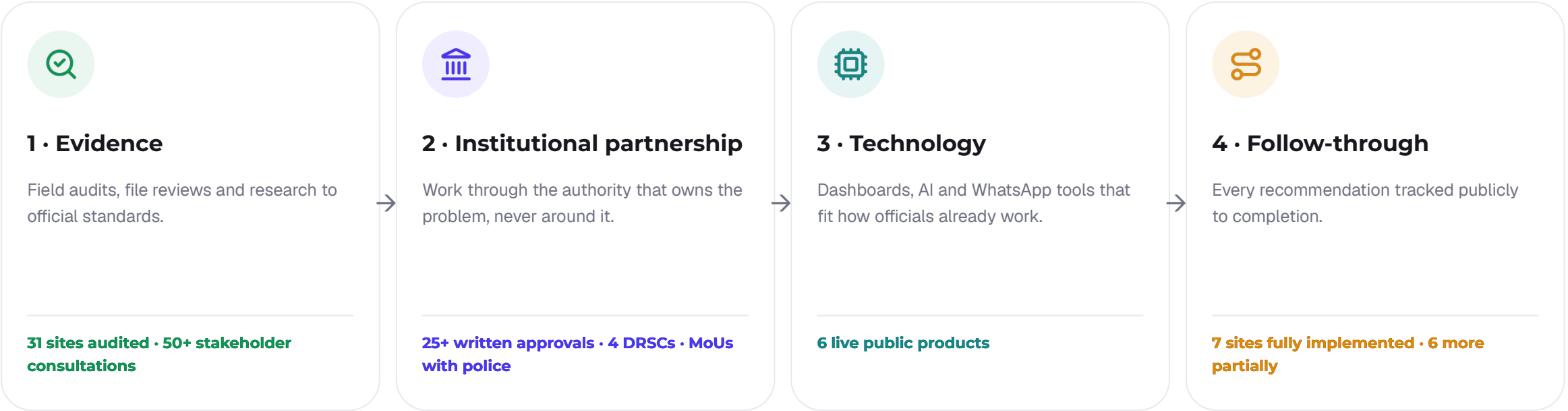


Where we work today, 18 cities, north to south.

Backed by a US\$3 million, three-year commitment from Cars24 . Programmes, not overheads, receive 71% of the budget.

Our approach: work **with the system**, and prove it with data

Four steps, applied to every problem we take up, from a dangerous junction to a stalled compensation claim.



We do not replace the system and we do not campaign against it. We add hands, evidence and tools to work the system has already committed to.

Why Working Group 2, and what we bring to it

The Group's mandate matches the deepest part of our portfolio. Three focus areas where we are ready on day one.



Black-spot rectification at scale

Our audit-to-implementation pipeline is running in 18 cities, the Group's rectification agenda is our core work.



Standards for audits & speed management

IRC-anchored audit instruments, masterclass-trained teams, and a direct line into IRC H-7 via our advisor.



Protecting vulnerable road users

Pedestrian-first audits, the 300-rider gig-safety study, school-zone screening, evidence ready for VRU standards.

EXISTING CAPABILITIES WE PUT ON THE TABLE

31 trained audit teams

Public tracking portal

District pilots: GGM · SWD · Jaipur

IRC H-7 advisory line

7 sites fully built

Expert bench on call

SUBJECT-MATTER EXPERTS ALREADY ENGAGED ON THIS AGENDA



Dr. Richa Ahuja

IIT Kharagpur · road safety researcher



Prof. Geetam Tiwari

TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi · IRC H-7



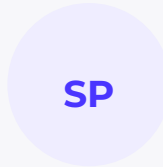
Abhay Damle

Ex-Joint Secretary, MoRTH



Dipak Dash

Senior journalist, Times of India



Sarika Panda Bhatt

Co-founder, Raahgiri Day

Six lines of work, one connected system

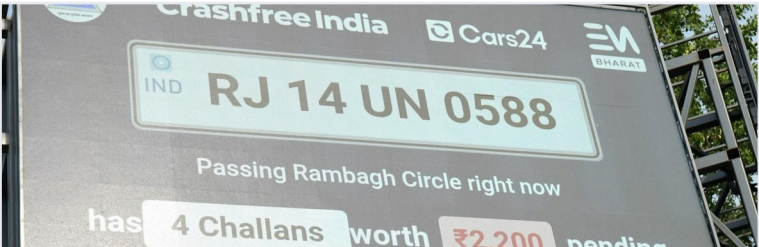
Audits create data · data supports policy · policy guides the field. Everything below is live today.



Project Rakshak

Student-led road audits, fixed with authorities

31 sites · 7 fixes fully built



SATARK enforcement

AI support that helps police find high-risk vehicles

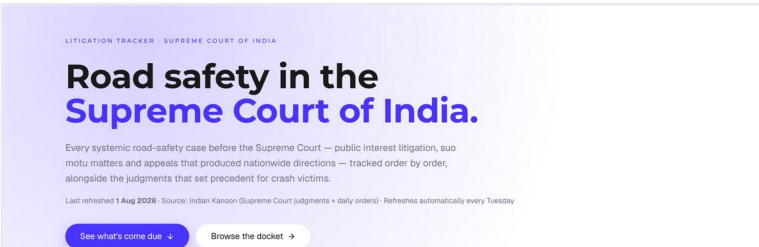
3,00,000+ vehicles screened



Victim support

Aasha chatbot, calculator, hospital helpdesks

100+ victims helped in first 4 days



Open public data

Four self-updating data platforms, free to use

36 states & 50 cities covered



Youth & policy

NextMile ideathon and national dialogue series

2,000+ participants engaged



Public campaigns

Road Safety Month with police & schools; MS Dhoni

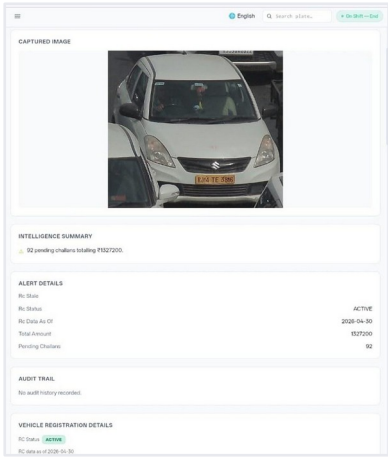
1M+ citizens reached

SATARK: AI that helps police stop the right vehicle

Built with Cars24 engineers. Reads number plates, checks government records, and alerts officers to repeat offenders, in real time.



Rambagh Circle, Jaipur, live plate, pending challans and dues on a public billboard.



Officer view, challans, RC & compliance status.

3,00,000+

vehicles screened

₹30 Cr+

pending challan value identified

350+

high-risk vehicles intercepted

70,019

vehicles found with pending challans

LIVE · Jaipur & Bengaluru

NEW · Gurugram

Bengaluru's Trinity Circle billboard was India's first, covered by Deccan Herald and national press. Pune and Ahmedabad are next.



Live public data platforms, free for any authority

Four platforms, each turning a scattered public record into structured, citable evidence. The two trackers are shown live, as captured this week.

Crashfree India

A Cars24 Commitment

RTI WATCH · PARLIAMENT WATCH

A CRASHFREE INDIA PUBLIC DATABASE

Every road-safety question in Parliament since 2014.

And the MPs who never asked one.

All 1,444 Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha questions on road safety — put to the four ministries that own it: Road Transport & Highways, Health (trauma care), Heavy Industries (vehicle standards), and Housing & Urban Affairs (pedestrian safety). Reconciled against Parliament's own records so nothing is missed. Search who asks,

Road Safety in Parliament: all 1,444 questions since 2014 across four ministries; 275 of 540 sitting Lok Sabha MPs have never asked one.

LITIGATION TRACKER · SUPREME COURT OF INDIA

Road safety in the Supreme Court of India.

Every systemic road-safety case before the Supreme Court — public interest litigation, suo motu matters and appeals that produced nationwide directions — tracked order by order, alongside the judgments that set precedent for crash victims.

Last refreshed 1 Aug 2026 · Source: Indian Kanoon (Supreme Court judgments + daily orders) · Refreshes automatically every Tuesday

See what's come due

Browse the docket

20

systemic cases tracked

6

pending before the Court

1

under compliance monitoring

13

disposed with directions

191

orders indexed

30

precedent judgments

Supreme Court Litigation Tracker: 20 systemic cases, 191 orders indexed, 30 precedent judgments. Refreshes every Tuesday.

Road-Infrastructure Defect Repository

DAILY · 07:00 IST

An AI pipeline reads local-language news from 146 districts every morning and turns road-defect reports, potholes, missing signage, unlit stretches, into structured, mapped evidence.

146

districts scanned daily, 13 languages

07:00

IST auto-run, every day

Crash Data Dashboard

ANNUAL · OPEN DATA

MoRTH's annual 'Road Accidents in India' books as a usable product: report cards for 36 states and 50 cities, every number reconciled against the printed books, open licence (CC-BY).

485

people killed per day (RAI 2024)

36+50

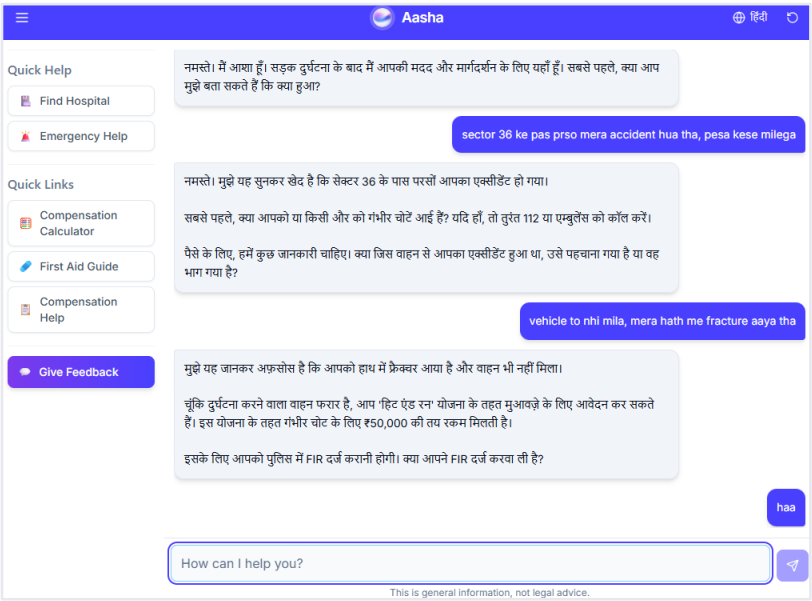
state and city report cards

Crashfree India · Expression of Interest — Working Group 2

09 / 28

Help a family can actually use, in their language

From the first hours after a crash to the final compensation order, on WhatsApp, on paper, and in person.



Aasha, live on WhatsApp, 24/7, multilingual, step-by-step guidance on rights, schemes and documents.

Aasha chatbot, India's first AI legal companion for crash victims, no app, no portal, just WhatsApp and voice.

Hospital helpdesks, Legal desks in trauma wards, 100+ victims supported in the first four days.

The Calculator, a sample estimate computed on SC principles.

Compensation Calculator, Free instant estimates on Supreme Court principles (Sarla Verma, Pranay Sethi).

Plain-language education, Comics and Hindi guides on all three compensation routes, NALSA 15100 and the Cashless Treatment Scheme 2025.



'Meet Aasha' comic, legal education families actually read.

Young talent and senior experts, working the same problem

A steady pipeline of engineers and policy minds, so road safety work never runs out of hands.



NextMile: Road Safety Policy Ideathon, grand finale, 28 Sep 2025, New Delhi.

2,000+

participants

250+

concept notes

700+

teams

10

finalist teams



National Road Safety Implementation Forum, IIT Delhi: 60+ experts from MoRTH, WHO, UNICEF, iRAP and CSIR-CRRI reviewed the work.

Mentors and jury from the Government of Rajasthan, NIUA, OMI, NASSCOM and CSEP judged the student teams; winning tracks now feed our audit and research pipeline.

National Road Safety Dialogue Series

200+ live attendees; speakers from MoRTH, CIRT, AIIMS Trauma Centre, CSIR-CRRI and ARAI.

Three sessions so far

Bus safety · Delivery rider safety · Good Samaritan law & the Cashless Treatment Scheme.

Advocacy on video

Our YouTube channel documents hazards and fixes on camera: ground-audit walkthroughs, Dialogue Series recordings and victim-education explainers. A public record any authority can cite.

Next: 'Be a Rakshak' university chapters at IITs, NITs and SPAs.

Road Safety Month 2026, run **with the system**

With district police, schools, hospitals and delivery platforms, in Hindi and local languages.



National Road Safety Month rally, on the road with district traffic police, Jan 2026.

1M+ citizens reached across campaigns in year one.



CFI stall at a government office



Materials briefing with police staff



School programme with certificates



Delivery-rider outreach, Swiggy & Instamart

MS Dhoni gives road safety a national voice



MS Dhoni, Goodwill Ambassador, announced April 2026.

Dhoni's voice powers 'Be a Rakshak', school-zone safety and compensation-awareness campaigns.

"We already know what is going wrong. What we need now is more responsibility, more discipline, more respect for life."

MS Dhoni, at the National Road Safety Implementation Forum, IIT Delhi

AS SEEN IN THE PRESS



Hindustan Times, on our Pre-Hospital Care Primer.



ThePrint, on the NextMile ideathon finale.

Bloomberg

Deccan Herald

Economic Times

Fortune India

IndiaSpend

Scroll.in

The Wire

Times of India

Business Standard

The institutions around the work

As they appear in our working decks, engagement ranges from formal MoUs and written approvals to jury, mentoring and research collaboration.

AUTHORITIES & PUBLIC BODIES WE WORK WITH



UNIVERSITIES & INSTITUTES FIELDING AUDIT TEAMS



EXPERT & ECOSYSTEM PARTNERS



Plus: Jaipur Traffic Police & Gurugram Police (MoUs) · CPWD & district administrations · Bloomberg, Johns Hopkins, Centre for Green Mobility and PwC experts on juries and reviews.

A full-time team built for this work

Engineering, law, policy, product and field operations, under trustees who have led Indian road safety for a decade.



Amar Srivastava
President · Founder, Indian Road Safety Campaign · Member, National Road Safety Council



Deepanshu Gupta
Managing Trustee · Founder, IRSC · Global Youth Coalition for Road Safety



Gajendra Jangid
General Secretary · Co-founder, Cars24

THE FULL-TIME TEAM



Akhtar Hussain **Mission Lead**
IIT Delhi · ex-Cars24 · leads strategy, partnerships and MoRTH/NRSB engagement



Shubham Kumar **Policy & Advocacy**
NALSAR Hyderabad · legal research, RTIs, Justice Unserved co-author



Muskan Yadav **Programmes**
TISS · runs district programmes, DRSC work and helpdesk operations



Aastha Shreeharsh **Development Communications**
HKUST · donor & institutional communications, impact reporting



Rohan Sharma **Cause Marketing**
Campaigns with police & schools · Road Safety Month, NextMile outreach



Ishita Rathore **People & Culture**
Talent, volunteers and the 75+ intern engineering corps



Yuvraj Yadav **Operations**
Field logistics across 18 cities · audit-cohort and event operations



Lovish **Creative (Video)**
Video explainers, ground-audit films and the YouTube channel



Shipra Kushwaha **Creative (Graphic)**
Guides, comics and bilingual campaign material families actually read

In-house capabilities: road-engineering audits · legal & policy research · AI product development · district operations · behaviour-change communication. **Plus 75+ engineering interns and 31 student audit teams.**

Advised by the people who built India's road safety practice



Prof. Geetam Tiwari, Board of Advisors

Professor Emerita & Chair, TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi · Member, IRC H-7 Committee on Road Safety Audit



Piyush Tewari, Board of Advisors

Founder & CEO, SaveLIFE Foundation · Architect of the Good Samaritan Law · Zero-Fatality Corridors

JURY, MENTORS & REVIEWERS AROUND OUR WORK



Justice J.R. Midha
Delhi High Court (Retd.)



Abhay Damle
Ex-JS, MoRTH



Vaibhav Dange
Ex-Advisor, MoRTH



Dr. Maya Tandon
Sahayta Trust



R. Venkat Ratnam
Government of Punjab



Akhilesh Srivastava
ITS India · IRF



Gautam Singh
SaveLIFE Foundation



Aishwarya Raman
OMI Foundation



Neeraj Kumar
Tata AIG



R.S. Pandey
FICCI Road Safety



Dipak K. Dash
Times of India

Engaged through the National Road Safety Dialogue Series: Balraj Bhanot (ex-Chair, CMVR-TSC) · I.V. Rao (TERI; ex-Maruti Suzuki) · D.P. Saste (CIRT / ex-MoRTH) · Dr. Sushma Sagar (AIIMS Trauma) · Dr. S. Velmurugan (CSIR-CRRI), and jurors from OMI, NIUA, WRI, CII and Tata AIG.

Project Rakshak, in one sentence

Trained student teams, guided by senior road-safety experts, audit dangerous road locations, and Crashfree India walks each recommended fix through the road-owning authority until it is built.



Students audit

Teams from IITs, NITs and SPAs collect data on-site: traffic, conflicts, 900+ stakeholder surveys.



Experts verify

Mentors anchor every audit to IRC codes and MoRTH checklists before anything is proposed.



Authorities build

The fix goes to the PWD, corporation or NHAI in its own format, and we track it to completion.

Four phases each cohort: Research & problem identification → Stakeholder engagement & audits → Analysis & costed solutions → Reporting & authority engagement

Identification has outpaced rectification, **capacity is the constraint**

The knowledge exists; the pipeline that turns identified risk into completed engineering needs more trained hands.

13,795

black spots identified nationally (MoRTH)

5,036

permanently rectified so far (Parliamentary Standing Committee, 2024)

44

certified Road Safety Auditors on the national registry (July 2026)

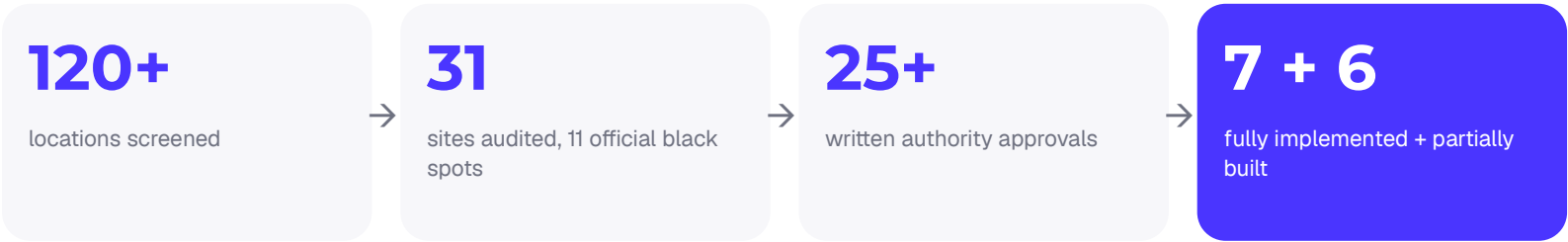
Low-cost engineering measures, raised crossings, traffic calming, lighting, safer intersections, reduce crashes by 20–80% where applied (iRAP & PIARC evidence). What limits progress is steady, supervised auditing capacity and follow-up, working under the road-owning authority.

Project Rakshak was designed for precisely this constraint: trained auditing capacity that supports road-owning agencies, and tracks every fix to completion.



Guntur, Andhra Pradesh, drainage correction underway after audit.

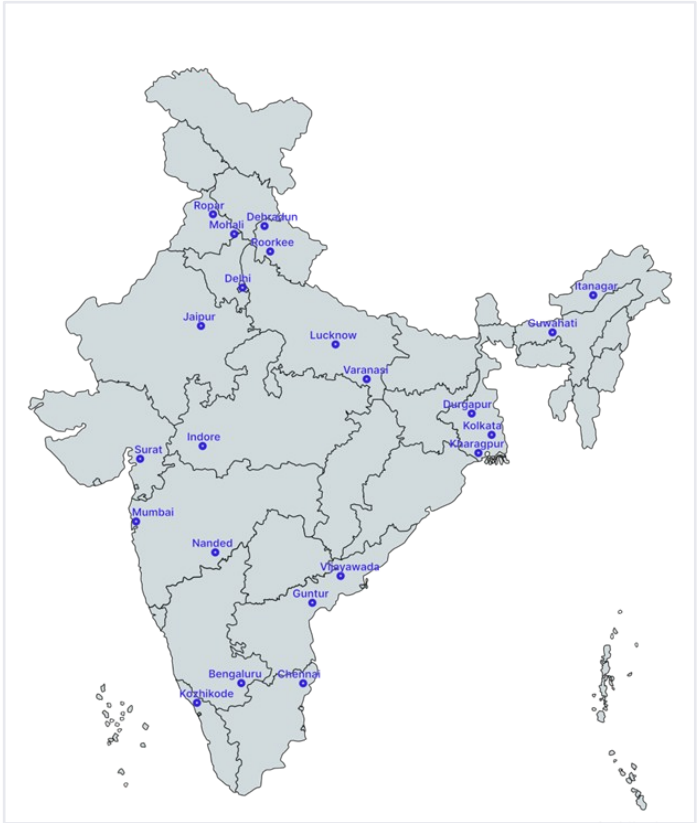
Cohort 1: a national footprint, now delivering



31 student teams · 20 institutions including nine IITs · 900+ stakeholder surveys · 17 subject-matter experts guiding and reviewing every audit

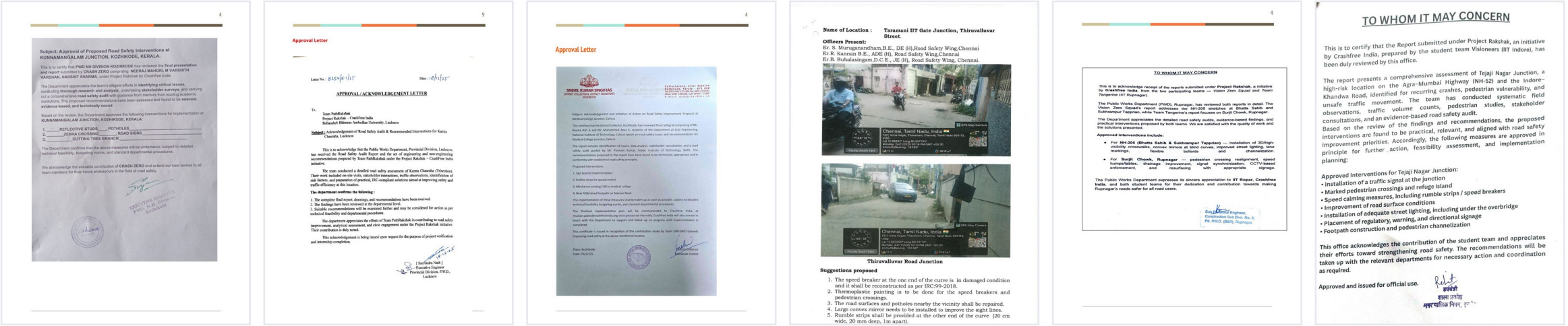
North: Ropar, Dehradun, Roorkee, Delhi, Lucknow, Varanasi · East: Guwahati, Durgapur · West & Central: Indore, Mumbai, Surat · South: Vijayawada, Guntur, Kozhikode, Chennai, among 18 cities.

Estimated 20–50% crash reduction at treated sites once complete, based on WHO / iRAP evidence for these counter-measures; we will verify with before-and-after data as implementations finish.



Cohort-1 sites across India.

Approvals in writing, from the authorities that own the roads



A sample of the 25+ approval and acknowledgement letters issued by public works and district authorities.

APPROVING AUTHORITIES INCLUDE

PWD Kerala

PWD Uttar Pradesh

PWD Punjab

CPWD + Addl. Collector, Indore

ADDA Durgapur

R&B Andhra Pradesh

GCC Chennai

BMC Mumbai

From approval to construction, and to completion

Live status from our public implementation tracker, August 2026.



Parking rationalisation, Durgapur



Fresh markings, Guntur



Footpath construction, Indore



Signage, Mumbai

7 sites fully implemented

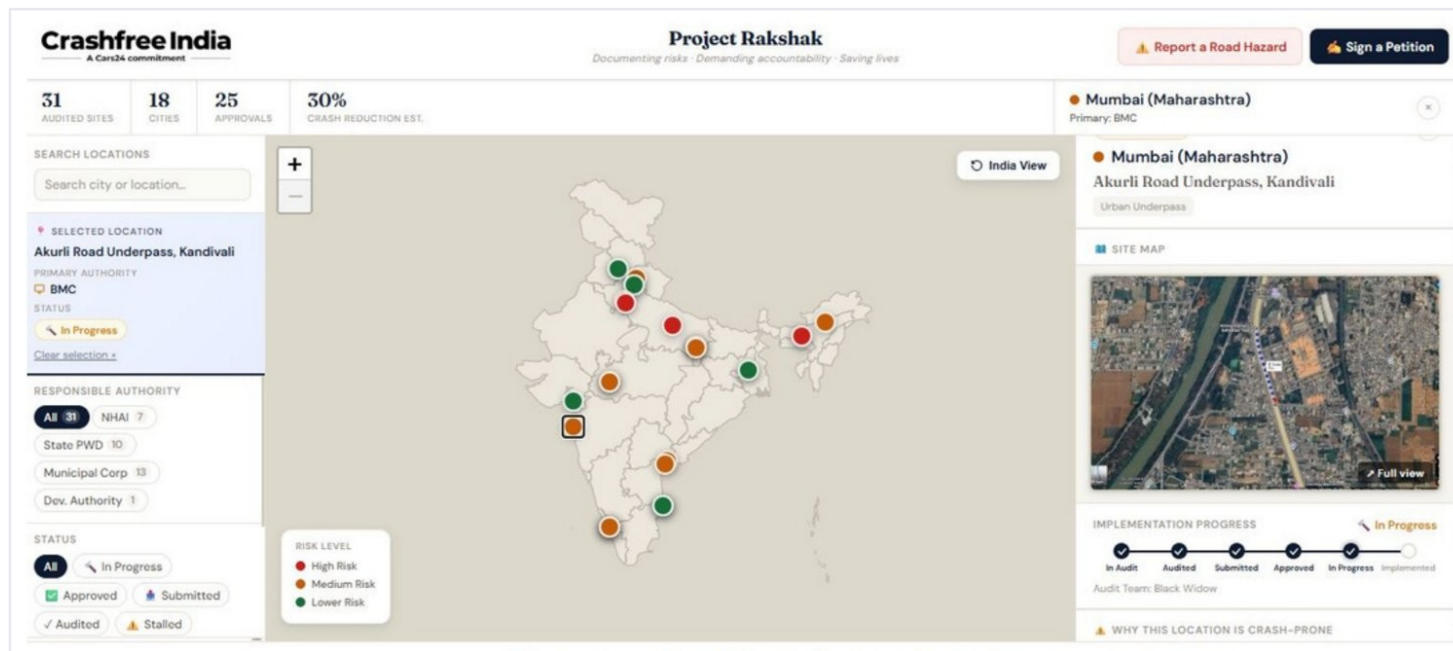
Outer Ring Road (Delhi) · IIT Madras Taramani Gate (Chennai) · Dafi Toll Plaza (Varanasi) · Akurli Road Underpass (Mumbai) · C-49 Commercial Area (Durgapur) · Chuttugunta Circle (Guntur) · Rau Gol Square (Indore)

6 more partially implemented : Kunnamangalam & Chevayur (Kozhikode), TIDEL Park (Chennai), Shivpur (Varanasi), Tejaji Nagar (Indore), Civil Lines (Roorkee); action initiated at further sites.

MARQUEE CASE, OUTER RING ROAD, SOUTH DELHI

On our audit, PWD built a continuous 1.8 m accessible pedestrian corridor, upgraded drainage at ponding sites, installed bollards against footpath encroachment, and deployed camera-backed speed-feedback boards.

A public dashboard tracks every site to completion



Live public dashboard, every site, its authority, risk level and implementation stage.



Every site tracked

From submission through approval to completed construction, regardless of who audited it.



The PRAGATI parallel

The PM's PRAGATI platform showed what visible follow-up does for stuck projects. Same principle here, for road safety fixes.



What the Board gains

An honest, live read on how quickly road-owning agencies can act, evidence for capacity planning, not just compliance.

Anchored to the codes **your engineers already use**



IRC codes & MoRTH checklists

Every audit instrument is built on them, nothing bespoke, nothing incompatible.



A line into IRC H-7

Prof. Geetam Tiwari, member of the IRC H-7 Committee on Road Safety Audit, chairs our advisory work.



Masterclasses before fieldwork

Prof. Tiwari on the Safe System approach; Dr. S. Velmurugan (CSIR-CRRI) on IRC-131 and SP-55.



Handover in the authority's format

Findings arrive as the PWD or corporation needs them, ready to action, tracked publicly after.



Authority engagement is continuous, audit teams present to the engineers who own the road.



Seventeen experts work with us on infrastructure improvement

Academics and practitioners who guide the student teams through fieldwork and independently review every audit before it reaches an authority.

AK

Amandeep Kumar

Urban Transport Planner, KPMG

AB

Dr. AVA Bharat Kumar

Asst Prof., Vignan University

AS

Asha SVT

Ph.D. Scholar, IIT Delhi

PK

Parveen Kumar

Ph.D., IIT Delhi

RK

Rashmeet Kaur

Ph.D., IIT Delhi

RK

Rajat Kalsi

Road Safety Expert

PA

Priyanshu Aman

Ph.D., IIT Delhi

MN

Mehraab Nazir

Ph.D., IIT Delhi

HK

Dr. Hemant Kumar Suman

Asst Prof., CTRANS, IIT Roorkee

SS

Dr. Shriniwas S Arkatkar

Professor, SVNIT Surat

SP

Dr. Sandeep Peeke

Asst Prof., SPA Vijayawada

PK

Dr. Purnima K Chowdhury

Asst Prof., SPA Bhopal

AB

Dr. Anshu Bamney

Asst Prof., IIT Mandi

VS

V. Sai Sesidhar

Ph.D., IIT Kharagpur

AS

Ashish Shrivastava

Engineer, Traffic & Transport Planning

MS

Mridul Sharotary

Planner, EY

KK

Kushal Khivansara

TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi

From IIT Delhi, IIT Roorkee, IIT Mandi, IIT Kharagpur, SVNIT, SPA Vijayawada, SPA Bhopal, Vignan University, KPMG and EY , the same mix of academia and practice the Working Group draws on.

Built to be institutionalised: not built to depend on us

Three audit tracks matched to road types, and a role for CFI that narrows over time.

Track A, Institutional	Track B, NGO partners	Track C, Certified RSAs
IIT / NIT / SPA teams under expert mentors	Field teams; desk-reviewed and re-verified by CFI	CSIR-CRRI-certified auditors, full IRC SP-88
Urban arterials, in-town state highways, district roads	District & peri-urban corridors	National highways, complex junctions

Today	CFI runs cohorts, quality-controls audits and stewards the public portal.
Next	Rakshak Audit Manual v1.0 codifies the method; universities field their own teams; NGOs run Track B directly.
Mature	States engage certified RSAs for Track C without CFI as intermediary; the portal remains the shared public record.

A growing evidence base on those most at risk

Roughly 70% of India's road crash fatalities are vulnerable road users, pedestrians, motorcyclists, bicyclists.



Gig & delivery riders

'When Risks Become Routine' (Feb 2026): incentive pressure, helmet compliance and training gaps, 300+ rider study, Delhi NCR.



Pedestrian-first audits

Rakshak audits document crossings, footpaths and lighting as designable protections, 900+ stakeholders consulted.



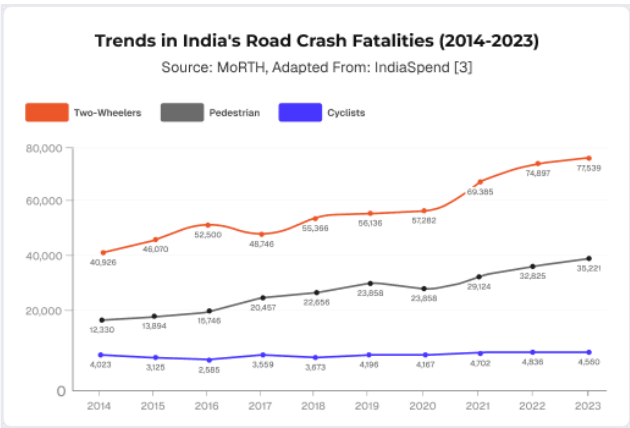
School zones

College-led, standards-based school-zone screening under exploration as the next extension of the audit platform.



Enforcement that protects VRUs

SATARK helps police prioritise the small share of vehicles with the worst records, targeted, fair, technology-led.



Fatality trends by road-user type, 2014–2023 (MoRTH; via IndiaSpend).



Four concrete offers to Working Group 2

All four are ready today, need no funding from the Board, and can begin within weeks.

- 1

Ready evidence for standard-setting

Site-level audit data, crash-pattern analysis and costed intervention designs across emerging hotspots and official black spots, for rectification protocols and speed-management guidance.
- 2

A live testing ground

Active district relationships in Gurugram, South-West Delhi and Jaipur offer a ready pipeline to pilot or stress-test draft recommendations before national rollout.
- 3

Ground-level implementation diagnostics

Granular, field-verified insight into how DRSCs and road-owning agencies actually move, meeting cadence, data use, follow-through.
- 4

Technical bench strength on request

Our academic and expert network stands ready for drafting, review and technical input on road design, speed and VRU standards.

We would be honoured to contribute to Working Group 2.

Our evidence, our district relationships, our technology and our expert bench are available to the Board, in whichever form is most useful.

"We already know what is going wrong. What we need now is more responsibility, more discipline, more respect for life."

MS Dhoni · Goodwill Ambassador, Crashfree India



crashfreeindia.org



akhtar@crashfreeindia.org · helpdesk@crashfreeindia.org